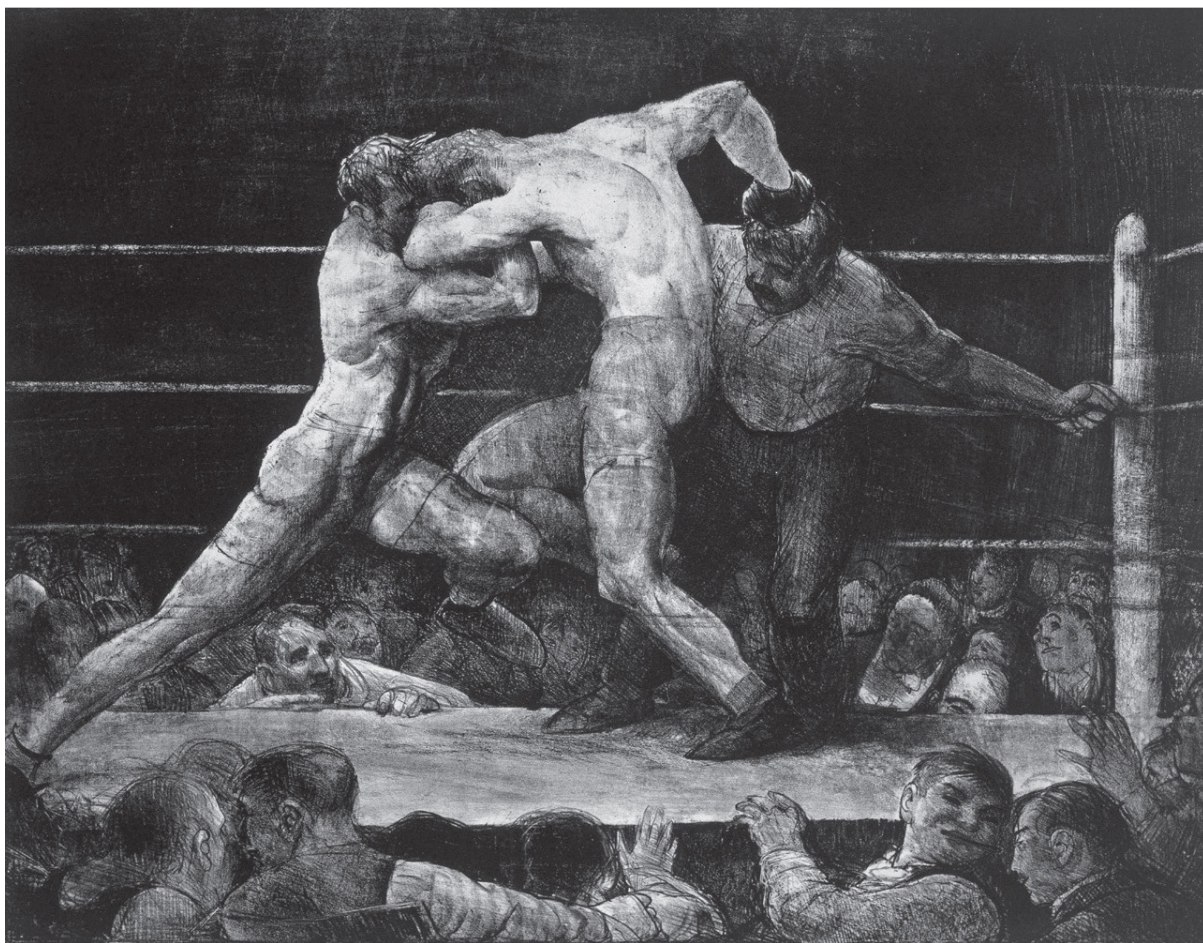


Ashcan School

Developing from American Realism, several artists began painting daily life in poor neighbourhoods, notably in New York where they lived between 1896 and 1904. With a spontaneous, unrefined style, they created harsh images of poverty and became known as the Ashcan School. They included Robert Henri (1865–1929), John Sloan (1871–1951), Everett Shinn (1876–1953), George Luks (1867–1933), William Glackens (1870–1938) and George Bellows (1882–1925). Some had met while studying with the Realist Thomas Anshutz (1851–1912) at the Pennsylvania Academy of Fine Arts, while others met working as illustrators in Philadelphia newspaper offices. With Parisian training and a bold, painterly style, Henri was the School's leader.

Most painted vulnerable people using a direct style with dark tonal contrasts and gestural brushwork. Edward Hopper (1882–1967) is often linked with them, but he said that unlike Ashcan art, his work did not show rough elements of life, only aspects of America that were not always seen.



Bellows, *A Stag at Sharkey's*, 1917